

ETHICAL CHIC

Fashion goes green as cotton becomes cool and organic takes centre-stage at fashion's biggest trade fair

■ By Kimi Dangor

Less is more and white is right. Trend forecasters are already turning new tricks for the spring-summer showing. But on the runway and off it too, Indian fashion seems to be making a new style statement this season—it's cool to care.

Even as Day One of Wills Lifestyle India Fashion Week (WIFW) drew to a close at Pragati Maidan, Delhi, green had declared itself as the new black. And while it might not literally be the hue to sport this spring-summer, couturiers with a conscience are making sure being environmentally friendly is trendier than the new Fendi "B" Bag.

As prêt-a-porter Paris plays host to a "so ethic" section annually, the 'Fashion is in my Nature' trade show is

KNICK-KNACKS

ALL AIR: There were old-fashioned loudspeakers lining the ramp. Even as we were waiting for some loud music to blare, the voice-over at Rajesh Pratap Singh's show told us to breathe in and breathe out. A breath of fresh air, indeed.

MAIDEN WALK: She has the oh-so-skinny frame and attitude to boot. Bollywood babe Kangana Ranaut is always dressed in designer threads. So it's only natural that she's finally stepping out on to the fashion week ramp as the show-stopper at designer Varun Bahl's show.

RE-TAKE: Following Arjun Khanna's defection to the Lakme Fashion Week, here comes news that not only are Falguni & Shane Peacock and Shantanu & Nikhil showing their collection at WIFW, they are also taking their creations to the Mumbai ramp.



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also causing a visible buzz in the French capital. While the UK fashion fraternity plays up the 'Is Green the New Black?' campaign and London Fashion Week introduces the "Esthetics" section, Brazil celebrates a glorious green-themed fashion week. And as environment and global warming are colouring the foreign fashion-scape, Indian couture circles are only just waking up to the organic oeuvre that is sweeping ramps world-wide.

Even if the venue at Pragati Maidan is as close to nature as some fashionistas have ever been, WIFW's latest seasonal offering in the Capital has more than a whiff of the natural and the elemental.

Earlier designers had made

ANITA DONGRE

GREEN USP

For her, a collection is a "fashion movement" that encourages the use of textiles made with the help of eco-friendly techniques. She is currently working on making a strong fabric, woven organically and coloured in vegetable dyes.

